

DAY 03 OF 05

KNEE + QUAD RESET

Fix the patellar load before it becomes a problem.

03

Knee pain after pickup isn't random. It's quad dominance without the posterior chain to balance it, and patellar tendons that have never been progressively loaded. Today you start loading them right.

TODAY'S PROTOCOL

01 SPANISH SQUAT

3 × 10 REPS · 3 SEC HOLD AT BOTTOM

Use a strap or post for support. Heels flat, squat deep, hold 3 seconds at the bottom. This is direct patellar tendon loading — the kind that actually prevents tendinopathy.

02 VMO LUNGE

3 × 8 EACH LEG

Front foot elevated slightly on a small step or plate. Drop the back knee slowly. You'll feel the inner quad (VMO) firing hard. That's the muscle that prevents your knee from caving on landings.

03 SINGLE-LEG GLUTE BRIDGE

2 × 12 EACH LEG

One leg in the air, drive through the heel on the planted foot. Squeeze hard at the top. This balances the quad dominance most hoopers have from years of running without posterior chain work.

NOTE The Spanish Squat is direct patellar tendon work. Don't skip it. The VMO lunge is why your inner knee stabilizes (or doesn't) on lateral cuts.